His newspaper column the following day accused me of being ‘so up his own arse, he thinks he is untouchable as captain’. For good measure, he added: ‘Cook acts as if he is the best captain England have ever had. He is living in cloud-cuckoo land about his captaincy ability.’ He described my relationship with Strauss as being too cosy.

We would make up, over time, but he was in no mood to toss white roses at my feet when we met, coincidentally, that day at the Lone Star restaurant on the west coast of Barbados. Since the match had ended early, I was out with Alice, Trotty and his wife Abi. Geoffrey was hosting a touring party of fifteen cricket lovers.

Given Dutch courage by a couple of lunchtime liveners, I wandered over and asked for a word, at his convenience. ‘Let’s do it now,’ he said, excusing himself from his guests. I knew he was serious when he brought over his favourite cushion to sit with us. With a deep breath, and without using one of his trademark sticks of rhubarb, I opened the batting.

‘Geoffrey,’ I said, ‘you and I have got on really well throughout my career. I’ve really appreciated you being a massive supporter of mine. I have absolutely no problem with you attacking how I bat, or with you criticizing my captaincy, because that is your job as a pundit. But to attack me personally in your column, as being arrogant, in a “who does he think he is?” sort of way, was wrong.’

Boycott fixed me with a gimlet eye. ‘I think I’ve got the right to do that, because you slagged off a Yorkshireman in that radio interview,’ he said. ‘I was just defending him. You upset a Yorkshireman, so me being a Yorkshireman, I just went for you, no problem. What do Joe Root and Jonny Bairstow and all the Yorkshiremen in your team think of you now, then? You attacked one of us.’

His reasoning was distinctive, to say the least. We talked around the issues for about twenty minutes but Geoffrey, rather like his political heroine Margaret Thatcher, was not for turning. He was unapologetic, and not having my counter-argument, that my teammates were unconcerned by what they took as light-hearted comments at the end of a tour.

That storm in a Yorkshire teacup had blown itself out when I took a call from Strauss, who confided that he intended to sack Moores. I argued against it, from both a personal and professional point of view. I loved Peter as a bloke; he was a pillar of trust. He had been there for me in the Caribbean, when he’d understood the limits of my self-containment and I’d